

been often in his company. Thinking that he recognised the chief justice, he went in and had an interview which satisfied him that he was not mistaken, although Tresilian represented himself as a farmer on Sir John Holland's estate in Kent, come up to town in order to obtain redress for some wrongs done to him by the men of the Archbishop of Canterbury. The squire, pretending to believe him, went directly to the duke, his master, by whose orders he returned with a sufficient guard, and brought the unfortunate judge before the council. His fate was not long delayed; for, after a short colloquy with the duke, he was asked what he had to say why execution should not be done according to the judgment pronounced; and becoming as one struck dumb, so that he could not answer, he was led away to undergo his sentence. Froissart says he was beheaded, and after hanged upon a gibbet; but the parliament Roll states that he was taken to the Tower, and thence drawn through the city, and hanged at Tyburn.¹

Another less credible but more particular account relates, that his wife and children, with many tears, accompanied him to the Tower, and that she fell down in a swoon overcome with grief. It describes that, in his transit from the Tower, the hurdle on which he was dragged was frequently stopped that he might confess to the friar who attended him; and that he not only refused to mount the ladder till he was forced by blows to do so, but that, when there, he declared that he should not die while he had any clothes upon him; whereupon, on being stripped, many charms were found about his person, and he was actually hanged up naked. His body was buried in the church of the Grey Friars.¹

These events, it is agreed by all, occurred on February 19, 1388, 11 Richard II.; and the attainder against him and the

¹ Froissart, ii. 285.; Holinshed, ii. 794.

² State Trials, i. 117.